CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

WINDOW CLEANING OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Drones can spray a skyscraper. Suburban glass still gets cleaned by a person the homeowner trusts.

★ TL;DR — Around ~$45K on the site's scale for owners, startable in 1–6 months with no license. The catch: it's route and ladder work — income grows from storefront contracts and two-story homes, not one-off jobs. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

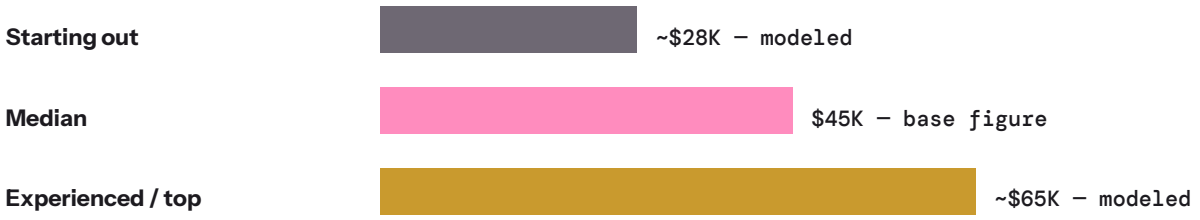
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Water-fed poles turned two-story homes into a ground-level job — the barrier dropped.
- Storefront routes are the steady base; residential is the seasonal bonus.
- Booking is software; streak-free glass is a human standard clients judge instantly.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Window Cleaning Owner is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A WINDOW CLEANING OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Clean interior and exterior glass, screens and tracks

- ✓ Run water-fed pole and traditional squeegee work
- ✓ Quote homes and storefronts; manage recurring routes
- ✓ Maintain pure-water systems and work ladders safely

Think: a milk route, but the delivery is light itself — recurring glass, recurring checks.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Scheduling, reminders and quote estimators handle the office. Drones wash some commercial towers — far from the residential core of this business.	Detail work on tracks and screens, spotting cracked panes, and being trusted inside homes — plus ladders that punish carelessness.

⚠ **Weather and winter slow residential demand; one-off work churns, so routes and contracts are survival.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Pleasant, visual work with instant client delight ✓ Very low startup cost for ground-level work ✓ Storefront routes pay in all seasons	✗ Ladders and heights become an everyday reality as you grow ✗ Cold water in cold months is miserable ✗ Clients judge perfection — streaks mean callbacks

Good fit? Meticulous, steady on ladders, and happy with calm, repetitive craft.
Bad fit? Heights terrify you, or details bore you.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — JOIN A WINDOW CREW	DOOR B — STOREFRONT ROUTE FIRST
Work for an established company to learn pure-water systems, ladder discipline and route pace. You'll also learn which contracts are actually profitable.	Start with storefronts: low glass, fast stops, monthly recurrence. A small route funds the water-fed pole setup that unlocks profitable two-story residential work.

Smart move: Sell the route, not the job: bundle windows with gutter or house-wash add-ons on the same visit to raise each stop's value.
Where you land after: Dense routes → a second cleaner → you manage contracts and commercial accounts.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	SET UP	BUY STARTER	BUILD A	ADD RESIDENTIAL	SYSTEMIZE RECURRENCE

STEP 1 — Learn the two methods

FREE · WEEKS

- Traditional squeegee work for storefronts and interiors.
- Water-fed pole with pure water for exterior multi-story work.

STEP 2 — Set up the business

WEEKS

- Register and insure; ladder-safety habits from job one.
- A simple per-pane and per-home pricing sheet.

STEP 3 — Buy starter gear

MONTHS 1-2

- Squeegees, applicators, buckets and ladders; a pure-water system when budget allows.
- A roof rack and vehicle signage turn the truck into an ad.

STEP 4 — Build a storefront route

MARKETING

- Walk a shopping strip with a one-page offer and a monthly price.
- Ten stores on one street beat thirty scattered.

STEP 5 — Add residential

MONTHS 2-4

- Offer interior-plus-exterior packages to homeowners on your routes.
- Twice-yearly recurring slots stabilize the calendar.

STEP 6 — Systemize recurrence

MONTH 6

- Route software, reminder texts and annual agreements.
- Raise minimums as routes densify.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: price every window cleaner serving your target streets.
- Days 1–30: gear ready; first storefront pitches walked in person.
- Days 31–60: route stops recurring; residential offers to route neighbors.
- Days 61–90: water-fed setup working; two-story homes on the calendar.
- Day 90: routes recurring — growth now means density and add-ons.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **CLEAN GLASS. FULL ROUTES.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.